

Aviation, Merchant Navy & Architecture Exams Guide

Complete Guide to Aviation, Merchant Navy & Architecture Exams in India
DGCA | CPL | AFCAT | AAI | AME | IMU CET | NATA | GATE AR | JEE Arch | PSC

SarkariSetu India - Comprehensive Exam Database

July 2026

SECTION 1: AVIATION EXAMS

Quick Stats

Total Exams Listed: 35+ | Categories: Pilot Licensing, AME, Air Force, AAI, Airline, IGRUA

1. DGCA (Directorate General of Civil Aviation) Licensing Exams

DGCA CPL Theory Exams

Commercial Pilot License theoretical exams conducted through Pariksha portal. 5 subjects: Air Navigation, Aviation Meteorology, Air Regulations, Technical General, Technical Specific. Min 70% required in each subject.

DGCA ATPL Theory Exams

Airline Transport Pilot License theory exams for experienced pilots. Subjects: Air Navigation, Air Regulations, Meteorology, Aircraft General Knowledge, Flight Planning, Flight Performance, Human Performance, Principles of Flight, Radio Telephony, Operational Procedures.

RTR(A) - Radio Telephony Restricted (Aeronautical)

Mandatory certification for pilots conducted by WPC Wing, Ministry of Communications. Held in major metro cities.

2. Aircraft Maintenance Engineering (AME) Entrance Exams

AME CET (Common Entrance Test)

National level exam for AME, Aeronautical Engg, Aerospace Engg, CPL, Cabin Crew, Airport Management, Ground Staff, BBA Aviation. Conducted by UDAI Aviation Pvt Ltd.

AME CEE (Common Entrance Exam)

National entrance for AME, Aeronautical Engg, Aerospace Engg, CPL, BBA Aviation, BSc AME, Cabin Crew, Ground Staff certification programs.

AIAEE (All India AME Entrance Examination)

National level exam by IIAE for Aircraft Maintenance Engineering courses. Phase-1 2026: May 3.

Aerospace CET

Aeronautical & Aerospace Common Entrance Test for B.Tech and License courses in Aeronautical, Aerospace, and AME. Regn 2026: Aug 1 - May 31.

IASAT (International Aviation Scholarship & Aptitude Test)

Scholarship and admission guidance exam for AME aspirants. Conducted by AME College.

3. Pilot Common Entrance Tests

PILOT CET

National level entrance for PPL, CPL, HPPL (Helicopter PPL), HCPL (Helicopter CPL) courses. Scholarship opportunities available.

Aviation JEE

National level entrance for CPL, AME, Aeronautical Engineering, and Aerospace Engineering courses.

4. IGRUA Entrance Exam

IGRUA Entrance Exam

Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Uran Akademi's own entrance exam for admission to Commercial Pilot License (CPL) training program. Premier flying training institute.

5. Airport Authority of India (AAI) Recruitment Exams

AAI JE ATC (Junior Executive - Air Traffic Control)

Recruitment for Air Traffic Controllers. Major career opportunity in aviation sector. CBT based selection.

AAI Junior Assistant (Fire Services/HR) Recruitment

Recruitment for Junior Assistant posts in various streams. CBT 2026 scheduled Mar 28.

AAI Junior Executive through GATE

Recruitment for JE in Engineering, Architecture, IT streams based on GATE score shortlisting.

AAI Apprentice Recruitment

Apprenticeship positions across various regions. Multiple notifications throughout the year.

6. Indian Air Force (IAF) Recruitment Exams

AFCAT (Air Force Common Admission Test)

Recruitment for Commissioned Officers in Flying Branch and Ground Duty (Technical & Non-Technical). AFCAT 02/2026: Regn May 20-Jun 19, Exam Aug 8, 2026.

NCC Special Entry (Flying Branch & Ground Duty)

For NCC Air Wing cadets. Flying Branch: No AFCAT written exam required. Aligned with AFCAT cycles.

IAF GATE Score Entry (Ground Duty Technical)

Recruitment for Ground Duty Technical Branches based on valid GATE scores.

7. Airline-Specific & Other Aviation Exams

Airline Ground Staff Recruitment

Individual airlines (IndiGo, Air India, SpiceJet, Akasa, Vistara etc.) conduct own selection processes. May include written tests, GD, interviews.

Airline Cabin Crew Recruitment

Direct recruitment by airlines. No single national exam. Selection: written test, GD, interview, medical.

DGCA Computer Number & FRTTO (Flight Radio Telephony Operator)

Additional DGCA certifications required for aviation professionals.

NCC Air Wing 'A', 'B', 'C' Certificate Exams

Internal assessments for NCC Air Wing cadets. 'C' certificate holders eligible for IAF NCC Special Entry.

Aviation Sector Overview

India's civil aviation sector is one of the fastest-growing globally. Career opportunities include: Pilot (CPL/ATPL), Aircraft Maintenance Engineer (AME), Air Traffic Controller (ATC), Ground Staff, Cabin Crew, Airport Manager, Aeronautical Engineer. Major employers: DGCA, AAI, IAF, Air India, IndiGo, SpiceJet, Akasa Air, Vistara, private flying clubs.

SECTION 2: MERCHANT NAVY EXAMS

Quick Stats

Total Exams Listed: 20+ | Categories: IMU CET, DGS CoC, DNS, GP Rating, Sponsorship, B.Tech Marine

1. Indian Maritime University (IMU) Exams

IMU CET (Common Entrance Test)

Primary national-level entrance for all maritime courses at IMU and affiliated colleges. CBT with MCQs. Syllabus: Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics, English, General Aptitude. Covers: DNS, B.Sc Nautical Science, B.Tech Marine Engineering, B.Tech Naval Architecture, MBA Port & Shipping Mgmt, M.Tech programs, PhD. 2026 exam: May 24 (reg closed Apr 24).

2. DGS/DGMA Certificate of Competency (CoC) Exams

CoC for Nautical Officers (Second Mate, Chief Mate, Master FG)

Written & oral exams for career progression at sea. Subjects: Navigation, Ship Construction, Cargo Work, Fire Safety, Meteorology. Conducted by MMDs under DGMA (formerly DGS). Signal Exam: monthly at MMD Noida.

CoC for Marine Engineer Officers (MEO Class IV, II, ETO)

Engineering CoC exams covering Heat Engines, Marine Electro Technology, Marine Engg Knowledge, Ship Construction, Stability, Environmental Protection. New exam module launching Apr 30, 2026.

3. GP Rating & Pre-Sea Training Exams

GP Rating Entrance Exam

6-month pre-sea training course. Exam by individual DGS-approved institutes. Subjects: English, Science, Mathematics, GK, followed by interview & physical fitness test. Leading to careers as General Purpose Rating on ships.

GP Rating at MTI (Maritime Training Institute) - SCILAL

GP Rating program by Shipping Corporation of India Land and Assets Ltd. DGS approved. Online test + interview + medical.

GP Rating at HIMT College

One of India's leading maritime institutes. Application for Jan 2027 batch opens Oct 1, 2026.

4. Diploma in Nautical Science (DNS) Exams

DNS Entrance (through IMU CET)

1-year pre-sea training program. Admission primarily through IMU CET. Qualifies for Second Mate FG Certificate after sea service.

DNS Sponsorship Exams (Company-Specific)

Shipping companies (MSC, Synergy, Anglo Eastern, etc.) conduct own sponsorship tests for DNS. Online test + psychometric + interview. Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, English, Aptitude, GK.

DNS at T.S. Chanakya / B.Sc Nautical Science

Premier institutes for DNS and B.Sc Nautical Science. Admission through IMU CET for T.S. Chanakya (under IMU).

5. B.Tech Marine Engineering Entrance Exams

B.Tech Marine Engineering (through IMU CET)

4-year B.Tech Marine Engineering at IMU campuses. Also accepted: JEE Main, GUJCET, CUSAT CAT, COMEDK UGET, TS/AP EAMCET, TMISAT (Tolani).

B.Tech Naval Architecture & Ocean Engineering

Specialized program at IMU. Admission through IMU CET. Covers ship design, offshore structures, ocean engineering.

GME (Graduate Marine Engineering)

For B.E./B.Tech graduates who want to enter merchant navy as engineers. 1-year course. Admission through IMU CET & institute-level exams.

6. Deck Cadet & Sponsorship Exams

Deck Cadet Sponsorship (Company Exams)

Major shipping companies (MSC, Synergy, Bernhard Schulte, Wilhelmsen, etc.) sponsor cadets. Online test: Math, Physics, Chemistry, English, Aptitude, GK + Psychometric + Interview + Medical. Appear only once a year per company typically.

Trainee ETO (Electro-Technical Officer) Exams

For candidates with electrical/electronics engineering background. Institute and company-specific entrance tests.

Deck Cadet through SIMA (South Indian Maritime Academy) & Other Institutes

Private maritime institutes conduct own entrance with IMU CET as base. Includes interview and medical examination.

Merchant Navy Sector Overview

The Indian Merchant Navy offers lucrative careers at sea. Entry routes: DNS (Deck Side - 1 year + Sea Service), B.Tech Marine Engineering (Engine Side - 4 years), GP Rating (6 months). Career progression: Deck - DNS > Second Mate > Chief Mate > Master (Captain). Engine - B.Tech/GME > MEO Class IV > MEO Class II > Chief Engineer. Average salary: Rs.3-8 LPA (cadet), Rs.15-50 LPA (officer), Rs.1-3 Cr+ (Captain/Chief Engineer). All institutes must be DGS/DGMA approved. Medical fitness by DGS-approved doctor is mandatory.

SECTION 3: ARCHITECTURE & TOWN PLANNING EXAMS

Quick Stats

Total Exams Listed: 30+ | Categories: Undergraduate Entrance, Postgraduate Entrance, State-Level Exams, Government Recruitment, Professional Certification

A. Undergraduate Architecture Entrance Exams

NATA (National Aptitude Test in Architecture)

Primary UG entrance for B.Arch conducted by Council of Architecture (CoA). Phase 1: Apr-Jun (Fridays & Saturdays). Phase 2: Aug (supplementary/vacant seats). Multiple attempts allowed within a phase - best score considered. Test: Drawing, Aptitude, Mathematics.

JEE Main Paper 2 (B.Arch & B.Planning)

For admission to NITs, SPAs, IIITs, CFTIs. Paper 2A: B.Arch. Paper 2B: B.Planning. Hybrid mode - Math & Aptitude (CBT) + Drawing (Pen-Paper). Two sessions per year. Best NTA score considered for merit.

JEE Advanced AAT (Architecture Aptitude Test)

For B.Arch at IIT Kharagpur, IIT Roorkee, IIT BHU. Only candidates who qualify JEE Advanced and opt B.Arch in JoSAA are eligible. Offline pen-paper exam. 'Pass' in AAT required for B.Arch admission.

M.Arch Direct Entry (for B.Arch graduates)

Direct admission to M.Arch at various universities based on graduation marks + interview. Some institutes require GATE AR or CEED.

B. Postgraduate Architecture & Planning Entrance Exams

GATE Architecture & Planning (AR)

National PG entrance for M.Arch, M.Plan, PhD programs. Also used for PSU recruitment (BARC, ISRO, HUDCO, etc.). Score valid for 3 years. Subjects: Architecture & Planning comprehensive syllabus.

CEED (Common Entrance Exam for Design)

By IIT Bombay for M.Des and PhD in Design. Relevant specializations: Industrial Design, Urban Design, Visual Communication. Score valid for 1 year.

M.Plan (Urban & Regional Planning) Entrance

Offered at SPAs (Delhi, Bhopal, Vijayawada), IITs, NITs, and state universities. Admission through GATE AR/CEED or institution-specific tests.

C. State-Level Architecture Entrance Exams

MAH B.Arch CET (Maharashtra)

For B.Arch courses in Maharashtra. Conducted by DTE Maharashtra.

KEAM Architecture (Kerala)

State-level entrance by CEE Kerala for architecture programs in Kerala colleges.

COMEDK UGET Architecture (Karnataka)

For private architecture colleges in Karnataka. Consortium of Medical, Engineering & Dental Colleges.

WBJEE Architecture (West Bengal)

By WBJEE Board for UG architecture courses in West Bengal.

OJEE Architecture (Odisha)

By Odisha JEE Committee for architecture programs in Odisha.

AMUEEE Architecture (Aligarh Muslim University)

University-level entrance for architecture at AMU.

TANCET M.Arch (Tamil Nadu)

By Anna University for PG architecture programs (M.Arch) in Tamil Nadu.

TS PGECET Architecture (Telangana)

By Osmania University for PG architecture courses in Telangana.

Karnataka PGECET Architecture

By KEA for PG architecture courses in Karnataka.

CEETA PG (Anna University)

By Anna University for PG programs including architecture-related courses.

D. Government Recruitment Exams for Architects & Town Planners

UPSC Architecture Cadre Posts

Group A & B posts: Architect, Deputy Architect, Assistant Professor (Architecture) in CPWD, Central Govt ministries, etc.

State PSC Architect Exams (BPSC, UPPSC, TNPSC, MPPSC, etc.)

Recruitment for Junior Architect, Assistant Architect, Architectural Assistant, Assistant Town Planner. Example: BPSC Asst Town Planner, TNPSC Architectural Asst / Planning Asst for Town & Country Planning Dept.

PSU Recruitment (BARC, ISRO, DRDO, HUDCO, NBCC, CPWD)

Architectural roles in PSUs. Many recruit through GATE score or direct recruitment. Municipal Corporations & Housing Boards also recruit architects.

CPWD (Central Public Works Department) Architect Recruitment

Central govt architecture posts through UPSC or direct recruitment. Involves design, construction supervision of govt buildings.

E. Professional Certification & Membership Exams

ITPI (Institute of Town Planners, India) Associate Membership Exam

Professional certification recognized for town planning positions in India. Required/recommended for various govt planning posts.

COA (Council of Architecture) Registration

Mandatory registration to practice as an architect in India. Requires recognized B.Arch degree + COA registration.

IIA (Indian Institute of Architects) Associate Membership

Professional body for architects. Associate membership enhances career prospects.

Architecture & Town Planning Sector Overview

Architecture in India offers diverse career paths: Academic (B.Arch 5 yrs, M.Arch/M.Plan 2 yrs), Professional Practice (Architect, Urban Planner, Landscape Architect, Interior Designer), Government (CPWD, Municipal Corporations, State PWD, Town Planning Depts), PSUs (BARC, ISRO, NBCC, HUDCO). Top UG entrances: NATA + JEE Main Paper 2 (B.Arch). Top PG entrances: GATE AR + CEED. Key skills: Design aptitude, drawing, mathematics, building science. Average architect starting salary: Rs.3-6 LPA. Senior/Principal Architect: Rs.15-50 LPA. Urban Planner: Rs.5-15 LPA. Govt Architect scale: Rs.44,900-1,42,400 (Pay Level 7+).

COMPLETE EXAM TABLE - ALL 3 SECTORS

Exam Name	Conducting Body	Type	Frequency
AVIATION EXAMS			
DGCA CPL Theory Exams	DGCA	Licensing	4/yr
DGCA ATPL Theory Exams	DGCA	Licensing	Quarterly
RTR(A) - Radio Telephony	WPC/MoC	Certification	2-3 months
AME CET	UDAI Aviation	Entrance	3/yr
AME CEE	AME CEE Org	Entrance	Annual
AIAEE	IIAE	Entrance	Annual
Aerospace CET	Aerospace CET	Entrance	Annual
IASAT	AME College	Scholarship	Annual
PILOT CET	PILOT CET Org	Entrance	3/yr
Aviation JEE	Aviation JEE	Entrance	Annual
IGRUA Entrance	IGRUA	Entrance	Annual
AAI JE ATC	AAI	Recruitment	Annual
AAI Jr Assistant	AAI	Recruitment	Per vacancy
AAI through GATE	AAI	Recruitment	Per vacancy
AFCAT	Indian Air Force	Recruitment	2/yr
NCC Special Entry (IAF)	Indian Air Force	Recruitment	2/yr
MERCHANT NAVY EXAMS			
IMU CET	IMU	Entrance	Annual
CoC Nautical Officers	DGMA/MMDs	Certification	Periodic
CoC Marine Engineers	DGMA/MMDs	Certification	Periodic
GP Rating Entrance	DGS Institutes	Entrance	Multiple/yr
DNS Entrance	IMU + Companies	Entrance	Annual
DNS Sponsorship	Shipping Companies	Recruitment	Per company
B.Tech Marine Engg	IMU + JEE	Entrance	Annual
B.Tech Naval Arch	IMU	Entrance	Annual
GME Entrance	IMU + Institutes	Entrance	Annual
Deck Cadet Sponsorship	Shipping Companies	Recruitment	Annual
Trainee ETO Exams	Institutes	Entrance	Per institute
ARCHITECTURE & TOWN PLANNING EXAMS			
NATA	Council of Architecture	Entrance (UG)	Multiple/yr
JEE Main Paper 2	NTA	Entrance (UG)	2/yr
JEE Advanced AAT	IITs	Entrance (UG)	Annual
GATE AR	IITs/IISc	Entrance (PG)	Annual
CEED	IIT Bombay	Entrance (PG)	Annual
MAH B.Arch CET	DTE Maharashtra	Entrance (UG)	Annual
KEAM Architecture	CEE Kerala	Entrance (UG)	Annual
COMEDK UGET Arch	COMEDK	Entrance (UG)	Annual
WBJEE Architecture	WBJEE Board	Entrance (UG)	Annual
OJEE Architecture	OJEE Committee	Entrance (UG)	Annual
TANCET M.Arch	Anna University	Entrance (PG)	Annual
UPSC Arch Cadre	UPSC	Recruitment	Per vacancy
State PSC Architect	State PSCs	Recruitment	Per vacancy
PSU Arch Recruitment	BARC/ISRO/etc	Recruitment	Per vacancy
ITPI Membership	ITPI	Certification	Annual

Total: ~70+ unique exams across all 3 sectors